

With TCL Back Face Culling, objects not visible to you are removed. This means better performance at no decrease in graphics quality

per-pixel lighting, allows you to add high detail to surfaces or objects without increasing the number of polygons.

Dither Mode

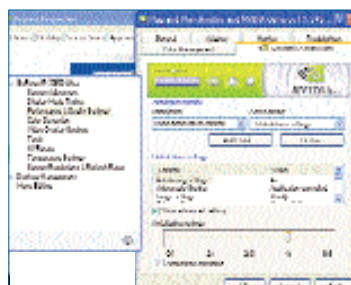
This is a mode setting for ATI drivers that works in tandem with Alpha Blending. It is instrumental in deciding the wave pattern created by water bodies and other similar effects. Alpha blending, on the other hand, is used to impart the transparent look to water or glass.

When enabled, this will hit performance, but will make game scenes on a beach or when swimming look very real.

Pixel Shader Version

The latest generation cards from ATI support Pixel Shader 2.0, while those of nVidia support 3.0. However, by default, the setting is 'Driver Default'. There are other options such as 1.0, 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4, 2.0 and 3.0 also available.

A higher version of Pixel Shader can only be selected if your hardware supports it and if you have installed the latest version of the display drivers and the appropriate version of DirectX (e.g., Pixel Shader 3.0 is supported only in DirectX 9.0c). You can even lower the setting to get better performance, albeit at the loss of image quality.



Adjust Anti-Aliasing in the nVidia control panel

Vertex Shader Version

This is similar to Pixel Shader, and choosing a lower Vertex Shader version will offer better performance.

TCL Back Face Culling

When you select this function from the driver, objects that are not visible to you are removed. This frees up a lot of bandwidth, which improves

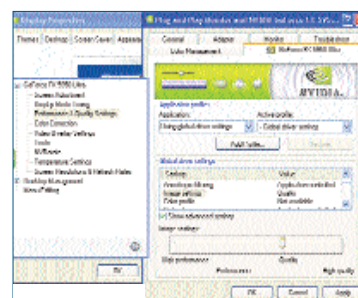


performance. This means better performance at no decrease in graphics quality!

OPENGL

3DNow!/SSE and SSE2

3DNow from AMD and SSE2 from Intel are optimisations built into the processors. Enable this feature to reap its benefits when playing OpenGL-



Adjust the image quality here in the nVidia control panel

based games—you'll get increased performance.

AGP Textures

If you haven't upgraded to a PCI-Express-based graphics card yet, and are still using an AGP interface-based graphics card, you should enable this setting. It provides OpenGL-based games access to your system RAM to store texture information when necessary. This option should be used if the card has about 64 MB of onboard RAM, and you are playing texture-heavy games such as *Doom 3* or *Far Cry*.

Video Memory Textures

When enabled, this only uses video RAM, and doesn't transfer texture information to system RAM. This feature should be enabled if your graphics board has more than 128 MB of RAM. However, cards with lower memory will experience a drop in performance if this feature is enabled.

Force 16-bit Texture

When enabled, this feature forces down colour depth from 32-bit to 16-bit. This improves performance but makes textures look flat. ■

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The above image is an example of how anisotropic filtering has been used to clearly display the floor tiles even at a long distance